

# Toxic Ingestion / Overdose

## History

- Substance or Substances (include alcohol, illicit drugs, prescription drugs, over-the-counter meds)
- Quantity and route taken (oral, inhaled, injected)
- Timing
- Reason (suicide attempt? accidental? criminal?)
- Other available medications and substances in home
- Other medical illnesses
- Possible trauma (falls? assault? incised wrists?)

## Specific Objective Findings to Look For

- Vital Signs—tachycardia, bradycardia, hypotension, hypertension, hypoxia, etc.
- Blood glucose – diabetic problems masking as OD
- EKG / rhythm changes – many drug overdoses cause arrhythmias!
- Pupillary changes
- Environmental clues – bottles, needles, etc.
- Mental / neurological status
- Skin findings – temp, moisture, track marks
- Medic alert tags – diabetic, medications
- SLUDGEM – organophosphate nerve agents; Salivation, Lacrimation, Urination, Defecation / Diarrhea, GI distress, Emesis, Miosis (constricted pupils)

## EMT/AEMT

- Follow General Medical Care Guideline
- Follow Adult Resuscitation Guideline

### Suspected narcotic overdose (OD) and altered mental status or respiratory rate < 10

- **Narcan** 0.5 – 1mg IN / IM
  - Titrate to effective respiratory effort and increased LOC, max 6mg

## Paramedic

- Call Poison Control if indicated (Medical Director on call must approve any TI/OD No Load)
- **NS/LR** 500 – 1000 mL IV/IO bolus to maintain SBP > 90

### Overdose Treatments (call Medical Direction for orders)

- Beta Blocker OD
  - **Glucagon** 3 mg IV/IO (if available)
    - May give additional 2 mg if no response
  - **Calcium Chloride** 20 mg/kg IV/IO over 10 minutes (max 1 g)
- Calcium Channel Blocker OD
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  - **Glucagon** 3 mg IV/IO (if available)
    - May give additional 2 mg if no response
- Cyclic Antidepressant
  - **Sodium Bicarbonate** 1 mEq / kg IV/IO over 2 minutes
- Anticholinergic / Organophosphate OD
  - Remove all clothes and decontaminate
  - **Atropine** 2-4 mg IV/IO
  - **Pralidoxime (2-PAM)** 600mg autoinjector (if available)
- Cocaine / Amphetamine OD with moderate agitation
  - **Droperidol** 5 mg IM/IV/IO may repeat every 3-5 minutes
  - Follow Behavioral Emergency Guideline